

Viking's Honour:

a players guide

Welcome to Viking's Honour — a game set in the mythic age of the Norse Vikings.

This is a saga of survival and legacy, where every decision carries weight and every challenge shapes your story. Whether through brute strength, clever strategy, or mystical insight, each player contributes to a tale of resilience, teamwork, and glory. This guide will walk you through the essential steps to prepare for the game and help your players create characters ready to forge their legends in a world filled with divine mysteries and mortal trials.





The 2d6 System

The core of Viking's Honour revolves around a simple yet flexible system using dice rolls to determine the outcomes of your actions. Most rolls use 2d6, with modifiers based on your character's skills and attributes.

Before You Begin

Before you dive into character creation, a few preparations will ensure you're ready to start your adventure:

What You'll Need

1. Dice:

Each player should have at least two six-sided dice (2d6).

2. Character Sheets:

Blank character sheets to record your attributes, skills, equipment, and backstory.

3. Village Sheet:

A shared sheet for tracking the progress of your settlement, including resources, facilities, and special events.

4. Writing Tools:

Pens or pencils to fill out sheets, track changes, and take notes.

5. Reference Materials:

The player handbook, which includes details about the Paths (classes), skills, and the game's mechanics.

6. Imagination and Enthusiasm:

Bring a sense of curiosity and creativity. Your actions and decisions will shape this world and your characters' destinies.

This book will guide you through the necessary steps to start your game.

Creating Characters

The first step in your journey is creating your character—a Viking ready to forge their fate. During this process, you'll choose a Path, and define your skills and equipment.

1. Choose Your Path:

Each Path represents a unique role and skillset, from the wild rage of the Berserker to the mystical guidance of the Seidr.

3. Select Skills:

Based on your play style, choose and train skills that reflect your character's expertise. Keep in mind that some equipment and abilities requires a certain number in a skill.

4. Gather Equipment:

Start with basic armor, a weapon, and one additional item like rope, a tool, or a crafting kit. Your choices reflect both practicality and personality.

This is the beginning of a saga. Whether you're striking deals with rival clans, exploring ancient ruins, or battling creatures of legend, every roll of the dice and every decision will bring your story to life. You'll craft a tale of survival, glory, and the bonds that hold your clan together.

Prepare well, roll boldly, and may the gods watch over your journey. Skål!

Gameplay Mechanics

Skill Checks and Rolls
- Actions, Skills, and Abilities: Use 2D6 (two six-sided dice) for most actions.
- Difficulty Modifiers:
  - Easy: Roll 1D6.

- Normal: Roll 2D6.
- Hard: Roll 3D6.
- Very Hard (Lorekeeper’s Wrath): Roll 4D6 (used when the Lorekeeper deems the player's attitude as unacceptable).

To succeed a roll the player must roll below the number on the appropriate skill stat.

Skill sets

Each character in Viking’s Honour has three categories of skill sets:

1. **Body** – Represents physical strength, endurance, and combat ability.

2. **Mind** – Governs intelligence, focus, and strategic thinking.

3. **Rune** – Tied to mystical abilities and boons granted by the gods, representing a connection to the spiritual world.

Body Skills

Run: The ability to cover ground quickly, whether in pursuit or escape. Useful for dashing across difficult terrain and increasing movement in combat.

Climb: Skill in scaling walls, cliffs, and other obstacles. It allows characters to reach high or difficult places, enhancing exploration and escape.

Swim: Proficiency in moving through water, essential for crossing rivers, surviving dangerous waters, and navigating underwater.

Melee: Competence in close combat, using physical attacks with weapons or unarmed. This skill influences combat effectiveness in hand-to-hand fights.

Endurance: Stamina and resilience, allowing characters to resist exhaustion, cold, and physical punishment.

Sleight of Hand: Finesse with small, quick movements, often used to pickpocket, manipulate objects, or perform tricks.

Hide: The ability to blend into surroundings, avoiding detection by enemies and wildlife.

Move Silently: Skill in reducing noise during movement, ideal for sneaking past guards, creatures, or ambushing foes.

Brute: Raw physical strength, used in tasks requiring power like breaking down doors, lifting heavy objects, or intimidating others.

Defense: The ability to avoid or withstand physical attacks through agility, resilience, or trained reflexes. Used to reduce or negate incoming damage in combat.

Parry: On a successful Defense roll, you may parry to deal damage on the opponent's turn.

Mind Skills

History: Knowledge of past events, cultures, and legends. It's useful for identifying artifacts, recalling lore, and understanding the significance of sites or events.

Medicine: Skill in treating injuries and illnesses. This includes knowledge of herbs, first aid, and treating poison or disease.

Mental Endurance: Resilience against fear, mental fatigue, and manipulation, allowing characters to keep their focus and remain calm under pressure.

Investigate: Sharp observation and analysis skills, useful for finding clues, uncovering hidden details, or understanding complex situations.

Nature: Knowledge of the natural world, including plants, animals, and weather patterns. This skill aids in survival, hunting, and tracking.

Archery: Proficiency with ranged weapons like bows, allowing for greater accuracy and effectiveness in long-range combat.

Finesse: Precision and agility in movements, used in delicate tasks like disarming traps, performing acrobatics, or handling fragile objects.

Convince: Persuasive ability, used to sway others' opinions, negotiate, and influence decisions.

Rune Skills

Connection: Ability to commune with the spirit world or gods, enhancing insight into the supernatural or gaining guidance from beyond.

Writing: Proficiency in reading and writing runes or messages, which can be used in rituals, enchantments, or leaving coded messages.

Deception: The skill of hiding the truth, lying convincingly, and creating illusions, useful in trickery and misleading others.

Insight: Deep understanding of people's motives and emotions, helping to detect lies, understand intentions, or foresee others' actions.

Religion: Knowledge of divine matters, rituals, and legends, enabling characters to interpret signs, understand religious customs, and perform sacred rites.

Rune Writing: The ability to inscribe and activate runes with mystical properties, which may grant blessings, protections, or insights during rituals.

All skills starts with a base 2.



Path of the Berserker

Berserkers are fierce warriors who draw strength from powerful animals like the bear, wolf, or boar. Known for their battle frenzy, they channel primal rage to overpower enemies, striking fear into their foes. Berserkers walk the line between beast and man, embracing a raw, untamed power.

Path of the Ranger

Rangers are skilled hunters and survivalists, adept at moving unseen and striking with precision. They are masters of the wild, knowing every plant and creature within their territory. Whether tracking prey or scouting ahead, Rangers serve as both scouts and defenders of their people.

Path of the Seidr

Practitioners of ancient Norse magic, the Seidr are mystical guides, healers, and prophets. They communicate with the gods and spirits, using Seidr rituals to gain insight or alter fate. Though powerful, their craft carries the weight of social taboo and risk, for they tread paths few dare to follow.

Path of the Rider

Riders are expert horsemen, fearless in battle and swift in pursuit. With a deep bond to their horses, they strike fast and disappear even faster. Riders are warriors of mobility and skill, charging into battle or flanking enemies with unmatched agility.

Path of the Skald

Skalds are the keepers of stories, history, and the wisdom of past generations. Warrior-poets and inspiring leaders, they rally their allies with tales of courage and triumph, strengthening resolve and guiding others through hardship. Skalds wield words as weapons, kindling hope and bravery in those around them.

Path of the Shieldbearer

Shieldbearers are stalwart defenders, standing firm against any threat. With shield in hand, they protect their kin and hold the line in battle. Known for their resilience and discipline,

Shieldbearers embody the Viking spirit of loyalty and sacrifice, offering strength where others might falter.

Path of the Volundr

Masters of the forge, Volundr smiths are renowned for their skill in crafting powerful weapons and armor. They imbue items with unique qualities, shaping the tools that keep their people strong. On the battlefield, a Volundr can repair gear and craft new arms, ensuring allies are always equipped for the fight.

Path of the Jarl

Jarls are natural leaders, commanding respect and inspiring loyalty. Skilled tacticians, they guide their allies with authority and strategy, setting the course to victory. Jarls are as wise as they are strong, seeing opportunities others may overlook and rallying their warriors to greater heights.

Path of the Draugr

The Draugr are warriors touched by death, seen as both feared and respected figures. Their endurance in battle and haunting presence can unnerve enemies, and they are said to bear the blessing—or curse—of Hel herself. Draugrs fight with a relentless will, often pushing beyond the limits of mortal endurance.

Path of the Niding

Cunning, deceitful, and unbound by honor, the Niding walks a path of shadows and stolen truths. Where others rely on brute strength or divine favor, you thrive on wit and guile. To some, you are a necessary evil; to others, a dishonorable outcast. But in your mind, the ends always justify the means.

Whether slipping unseen through the night, cutting purses under a tavern table, or weaving lies to sow chaos, the Niding is an artist of survival. While the world sees only treachery, you see opportunity, carving out a place for yourself in a harsh and unyielding land.

For every locked door, there is a key; for every unwatched coin, a hand; for every fool, a game to be played. You are the Niding, and the shadows are yours.

Combat System

Initiative
Is the combined Speed + Run skill
- Initiative Order is determined by the highest initiative score.
If equal scores, roll 1D6 vs 1D6 between the players/foes that is equal, highest takes the initiative

1. Attacking

- **Attack Roll**: The attacker uses their **Melee skill** for close combat. If they are proficient with their weapon, they add their **Preferred Weapon** skill bonus to the total.
- **Determine Success**:
    - Roll **2d6**. If the result is **equal to or below** the total of the **Melee skill**, the attack is successful, and the attacker deals full weapon damage.
    - If the roll is higher than the total, the attack misses.

Example:

- A player with **5 in Melee** attacks with a sword they are proficient with.
- The player rolls **2d6** and gets a **4**, which is a success (4 is below 5).
- Since the attack succeeds, the player deals the full **5 damage** from their sword.
- If the player attacks with a weapon they are not proficient with, they use the lower number of the damage result.

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2. Defense

- The defender rolls using their Defense skill only, without adding the armor's defense score directly.

- Armor Effect: Armor provides a fixed damage reduction rather than being added to the roll.

Determine Success:

- Roll 2D6. If the result is equal to or below the Defense skill, the defense is successful, reducing damage.

- On a successful defense, the damage is reduced by the difference between the Defense skill and the roll result. To a minimum of 1.

Armor Reduction: After applying the defense roll, subtract the armor's fixed reduction from the remaining damage.

Example:

The defender has a Defense skill of 3 and is wearing leather armor, which provides a fixed reduction of 1.

The defender rolls 2d6 and gets a 2, which is a success (2 is below 3).

Damage Reduction: The difference between 3 (Defense skill) and 2 (roll result) is 1.

Total Reduction: After applying the defense roll reduction and the leather armor
Result: The defender reduces the damage by a total of 2.

Summary of Combat Flow

1. **Attacker's Turn**:
    - Roll 2d6, aiming to roll **below the attack score** (Melee + Preferred Weapon bonus).
    - On success, deal full weapon damage.
2. **Defender's Turn**:
    - Roll 2d6, aiming to roll **below the defense score** (Defense skill + armor defense).
    - On success, reduce incoming damage by the difference between the defense score and the roll result. To a minimun of 1

Weapon Proficiency
- Weapon proficiency allows you to wield them with greater skill, reducing penalties or increasing bonuses.
- You find weapon proficiency on the page of the path you choose.

Abilities

General Abilities
Each character path in *Viking's Honour* gains access to specific abilities that enhance their skills or actions.

Examples:
- **Shield Wall**: When defending in formation, gain +2 defense for one round.
- **Quick Reflexes**: Gain +1 to defense rolls against sudden threats.

Seidr Abilities
For characters who walk the *Seidr Path,* abilities are more mystical, than magical.
Examples include:
- **Whispers of the Norns**: Gain insight into the future to reroll a failed check.
- **Runic Guidance**: Draw and interpret runes to answer questions about the present or past.

More on abilities on the ability page.

Exhaustion and Health

Exhaust Points
- Characters accumulate Exhaust Points from overexertion, injury, or failed tasks.
Most abilities cost some exhaustion.
  - Exhaust Points cause debuffs to your rolls.
  - Acumulationg 8 exhaust points grants one Permanent Scar.
  - If you accumulate too many, you may risk death.

Reducing Exhaustion:
-Rest
-downtime
-certain skills (like Seiðr's Soothing Touch)
can reduce Exhaust Points.

Permanent Scars
- Characters may receive permanent scars from injuries, wich affect mostly narrative and some game mechanics

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Character Progression

Experience and Leveling Up
- Characters gain **Saga points** for completing quests, defeating enemies, or role-playing significant events.
- **Saga points** represents players progress in the story.
- Accumulated **Saga points** allows you to increase skills, or gain new abilities.

Rest and Recovery

Short Rest

- A Short Rest allows players to regain a small amount of health, reduce Exhaust Points, and recharge certain abilities.

Full Rest
- A Full Rest at a safe location allows full healing, removal of Exhaust Points, and the recharge of all abilities.



Building Your Village:

A Guide to Crafting Your Viking Home

As you and your allies venture through the wilds, fight fearsome enemies, and face the trials the gods have set before you, the village you build becomes more than just a place to rest, it becomes your home, a sanctuary, and a symbol of your clan’s strength. Investing in the

growth of your village not only grants practical benefits but also weaves a deeper story of kinship, loyalty, and survival. The more you expand and improve your village, the more powerful and self-sustaining it becomes, able to support you on your journeys in unique ways.

Starting and Expanding Your Village

Village building starts with gathering resources from your quests. The **Homestead points** you earn together, along with currency and specific materials, can be invested in building and upgrading key facilities. Each facility provides its own benefits. Perhaps cheaper gear, improved healing, or specialized items that you won't find elsewhere.

Village progression

Experience and Leveling Up
The players have a joint sheet for the village.
Depending on player/ Lorekeeper style, this could be something to play in between sessions, over chat or something the players focus on in roleplay.

The village gains **Homestead points**, given by the Lorekeeper for completing quests or when gaining fame by neighbouring cities, or bands.
By reaching certain points, different facilities will be available to purchase and build.

Upgrading your facilities brings even greater benefits. Each level makes your village more robust, and at certain stages, new visitors, traders, and travelers may arrive, bringing fresh opportunities, quests, or even special training.

Creating a Legacy
Your village isn’t just a collection of buildings—it’s a reflection of your group’s journey, the battles fought, and the wisdom gained. Every time you improve it, you’re not only gaining practical advantages but also leaving a legacy for future generations. As you gather resources and upgrade facilities, remember that this village represents the enduring bond between you and your allies, a legacy that will live on through each victory and sacrifice.

How to Begin Building:

1. Gather Resources: Earn Homestead points, collect daler, and search for unique resources on your journeys.

2. Choose a Facility to Build or Upgrade: Decide with your allies which facilities would best support your needs.
3. Invest resources and Currency: Spend the required resources and daler to build or upgrade your chosen facility.
4. Roll for New Visitors: At Lorekeepers discretion when players level up a facility, there's a chance for a special arrival, a trader, healer, trainer, or someone even more mysterious.



LOREKEEPER

From this point it is only for the Lorekeeper.



Lorekeeper, the sacred role that bridges mortal deeds and divine destiny. the role of the Lorekeeper is a noble one. You are the unseen force. You are more than a guide to the players; you are the weaver of sagas, the voice of gods.
Your craft is in the details, every whispered omen, every weathered map, and every thunderous clash of steel. You are the hand that shapes the world they explore.

As the Lorekeeper, your responsibilities are vast, yet rewarding.
Your purpose is not to control the story but to allow the players to carve their own legacies.

You breathe life into villages, give voice to the winds that carry them across seas, and embody the spirits that challenge and bless their path.
Through your narration, their victories will resound louder, their struggles feel heavier, and their choices leave ripples that shape their world. You are both an ally and an adversary.

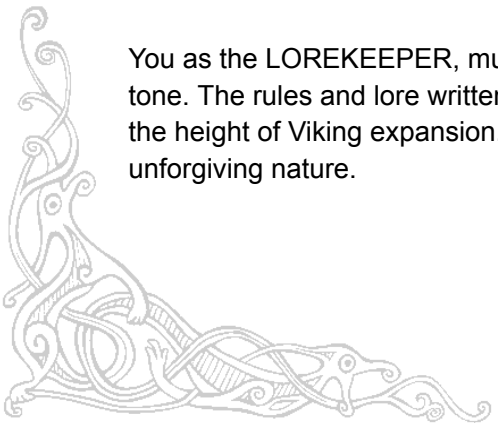
Within this section lies the foundation of their journey, rules, mysteries, and the keys to crafting tales of heroism and hardship

Introduce vibrant characters, both friend and foe, to inspire and test your players.

Build and grow settlements, breathing life into their home away from home.

Keep these words close: This is their story, and you are its keeper. Play fair, play bold, and play with purpose. Together, you will forge a saga worthy of the gods.

Before the game



You as the LOREKEEPER, must first Familiarize yourself with the campaign's setting and tone. The rules and lore written in this guide takes place between 850 and 950 CE, during the height of Viking expansion. Your players will navigate a world of gods, rival clans, and unforgiving nature.

Introducing the story's central conflict: a dispute with the players' former Jarl that forces them to establish a new settlement.

If you are familiar and experienced as a Lorekeeper/ Game master, you can use these resources and create your own story and setting.

2. Prepare the Materials

Player Handbooks: Ensure each player has access to the rules for character creation, skills, and the game's core mechanics.

Lorekeeper Tools: Have your game master's book ready, complete with notes on the setting, NPCs, encounters, and potential challenges.

Character Sheets: Provide blank character sheets for players to record their stats, skills, and inventory.

Village Sheet: Prepare the collaborative village sheet to track the group's settlement progress.

Dice: The game uses 2d6 for skill checks and specific rolls like combat or resource production.

3. Set Expectations

Explain the tone and style of the game. This is a story of survival, community building, and personal growth, with a balance of combat, roleplay, and resource management.

Discuss the collaborative nature of the game. Players will work together to develop their settlement, make decisions, and face challenges.

A good way to do this is to have a session 0, where the Lorekeeper introduces the setting and the players can create their characters together with the Lorekeeper.

Guiding Character Creation

The players will create characters who are exiled from their homeland, each bringing unique strengths and ambitions to the group. Follow these steps to guide them:

1. Choose a Path

Introduce the available Paths (character classes), each inspired by Viking culture.

2. Assign skill Points

Players distribute 14 points between the three categories of skill: Body, Mind, and Rune.

Body: Physical strength, endurance, and combat ability.

Mind: Intelligence, strategy, and problem-solving.

Rune: Mystical connection and divine favor.

Players assign skill points to specific abilities (e.g., Melee, Convince, Rune Writing). Each Path provides guidance on which skills align best.

Skill points can be raised to a maximum of 10.

3. Choose Starting Equipment

Each character starts with basic armor, a weapon, and a gear item. Players can select from the list provided in the handbook, and some comes with the paths they've chosen.

4. Determine Background and Motivations

Encourage players to think about their character’s backstory:

What drove them to join the group?

What do they hope to achieve in the new settlement?

Do they have personal goals or rivalries?

Preparing for the First Session

Before beginning the campaign, ensure the following:

1. Introduction to the World:

Give players an overview of the Viking age, the importance of settlements, and the gods' influence on their lives.

Explain the dispute with the Jarl and the urgency of establishing a new home.

2. Set Expectations for Play:

Discuss the balance of combat, roleplay, and resource management.

Emphasize the importance of teamwork and the collaborative building of the settlement.

3. Review Core Mechanics:

Skill Checks: Explain rolling 2d6 and meeting or beating the difficulty threshold.

Combat: Go over initiative, attack rolls, deflects, and damage calculation.

Village Building: Introduce the village sheet and resource management.

4. Start the Story:

Begin with the players' exile and the dangerous voyage across the seas. Use this as an opportunity for roleplay and initial challenges that introduce the game's mechanics.

Where to Start:

The Prologue

The players' tale begins in exile, driven from their homeland due to a dispute with their former Jarl. This sets the stage for themes of survival, ambition, and community building. A dramatic opening sequence can immerse the players immediately.

1. Opening Scene: The Exile

The group has been exiled from their home, leaving behind everything they knew.

The story begins aboard their longships, with the players navigating stormy seas en route to unknown lands. The storm serves as an immediate challenge that introduces skill checks, teamwork, and the game's dice mechanics.

As the storm calms, the group arrives at a foreign and untamed coastline. This moment provides a sense of relief and an opportunity for exploration.

2. First Encounters: Survival

The players must scavenge the beach and surrounding wilderness for supplies. This is an excellent time to introduce gear, resources, and minor NPCs, such as surviving villagers or stranded allies.

Initial challenges may include:
Finding food and fresh water.
Crafting basic tools or temporary shelter.
Defending against a small group of hostile wildlife or rival exiles.

3. First Settlement: The Founding

The players choose a location for their new village, balancing safety, access to resources, and proximity to potential threats or opportunities.

This is something that can be done together In a session 0, giving the Lorekeeper ample time to prepare a map.
This introduces the village-building system, with players starting to gather resources and decide which facilities to prioritize.

What the Lorekeeper Needs to Prepare

1. Maps

World Map: A broad map of the region, including:

Coastal landing points.

Nearby settlements (hostile or neutral).

Key landmarks (forests, rivers, ruins, mountains).

Village Map: A smaller, zoomed-in map of the players' chosen settlement location.

Include space for future facilities and upgrades.

Show surrounding resources like forests (lumber), quarries (stone), and wildlife (food).

Dungeon or Encounter Maps: If the story includes ruins, caves, or enemy camps, create small, modular maps for exploration and combat.

2. NPCs

Introduce a handful of NPCs to add depth and guide the players through early encounters:

Survivors: Fellow exiles who escaped with the players. Examples:

A skilled healer who is vital but needs the players' protection.

A disgruntled warrior who questions the players' leadership.

Hostiles: Early threats to the group's survival. Examples:

A rival Viking band also seeking to claim the land.

Local inhabitants suspicious of the newcomers.

Allies: Potential supporters or trade partners. Examples:

A wandering merchant offering supplies at a high price.

A druid or Seidr offering guidance in exchange for a task.

3. Key Story Elements

The Exile’s Legacy: Remind players of their connection to the homeland they left behind, such as family, friends, or unfinished business. These threads can emerge later in the story.

The Settlement’s Future: Introduce challenges to test the players' resolve and leadership, such as:

Harsh weather damaging their early camp.

A faction (or the Jarl’s forces) threatening their claim to the land.

4. Player Character Hooks

Encourage players to share their characters' motivations:

Why did they join the exile? What do they want to achieve?

How do they view the group’s leader (if one exists)?

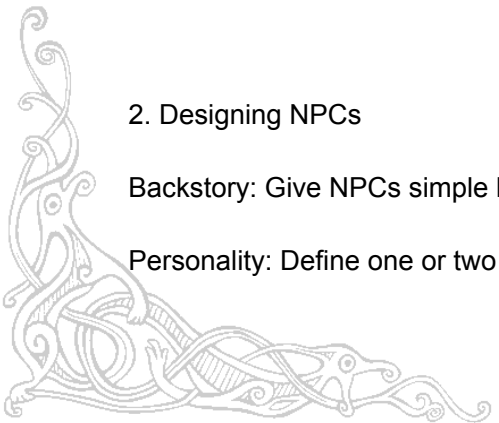
What skills or secrets do they bring to the settlement?

Procuring Maps and NPCs

1. Creating Maps

Use graph paper, online tools (like Inkarnate or DungeonFog), or hand-drawn sketches to create immersive maps.

Include landmarks and points of interest that align with Norse themes, such as sacred groves, ancient burial mounds, or stone circles.



2. Designing NPCs

Backstory: Give NPCs simple but engaging backstories.

Personality: Define one or two key traits (e.g., loyal, cunning, cowardly).

Motivations: Make NPCs proactive; they may request help, offer trade, or stir up conflict.

3. Item Procurement

Prepare basic equipment for the players to find or purchase, such as weapons, tools, and supplies.

Include unique Viking-themed items like a carved Seidr staff, a runestone, or a ceremonial helm.



Tips for the Lorekeeper

Start Small: Don’t overwhelm players with too many mechanics or decisions. Let them explore their new world gradually.

Adapt to Player Choices: Be flexible and let players take creative approaches to survival and settlement-building.

Focus on Immersion: Use descriptive language, sound effects, or props to make scenes vivid and engaging.

This foundation will ensure your story begins with excitement and a strong sense of purpose while giving you the tools to adapt as the narrative unfolds. Skål!